Petra Kelly



Born Petra Lehmann in Günzburg, West Germany, in 1947, Kelly later adopted the surname of her stepfather, an American army officer. When she was 12, the family moved to the US, where Kelly studied political science in Washington, D.C.

In 1970, Kelly returned to Europe. While working at the European Commission in Brussels, she joined Germany's Social Democratic Party, but grew disillusioned with traditional politics. She joined Germany's newly formed Green Party in 1979, and in 1983 was one of 28 members to be elected to parliament. Kelly campaigned on issues of environmentalism and human rights. In 1992, she and her companion, Green politician Gert Bastian, were found dead at her home in Bonn, apparently the result of a suicide pact.

Key works

1984 *Fighting for Hope*

1992 *Nonviolence Speaks to Power*

1994 *Thinking Green: Essays on Environmentalism, Feminism, and Nonviolence*

See also: Citizen science • Pesticides • Human devastation of Earth • Halting climate change